Psalm 2 — Приими мя, пустыни

“Receive me, O wilderness, as a mother her child”

IPA pronunciation sheet · sung in the Russian Church Slavonic tradition · text: 16th-century Russian penitential verse

Text with stress

Прии́ми мя, пусты́ни, я́ко ма́ти ча́до свое́, во ти́хое и безмле́вное не́дро свое́. Не брани́, пусты́ня, страши́лищи свои́ми отобе́гошаго от лука́вныя блудни́ца ми́ра сего́. О прекра́сеная пусты́ни, весе́лая дубра́вица! Возлюби́х бо тя па́че ца́рескых черто́г и позлаще́нных пола́т. И пойду́ в лу́зех по кра́сному твоему́ виногра́ду разли́чных цвете́ць твои́х, дыха́юще от во́здуха ма́лым ветре́цем, дви́жуще у древе́с ве́твие свое́ кудря́вое. И бу́ду, я́ко худ зверь, еди́н скыта́яся, и бе́гая челове́к и мно́го мяте́жныя се́я жи́зни, и седя́ пла́ча и рыда́я, во глубо́ком и ди́ком не́дре твое́м. О Влады́ко Царю́! Наслади́л мя еси́ земны́хо бла́го, и не лиши́ мене́ Небе́снаго Ца́рествия Твоего́.

Line-by-line IPA

1. Receive me, O wilderness, as a mother her child,

Прии́ми	мя,	пусты́ни,	я́ко
[prʲiˈimʲi]	[mʲa]	[pusˈtɨnʲi]	[ˈjako]
ма́ти	**ча́до**		**свое́,**
[ˈmatʲi]	[ˈʈ͡ʂado]		[svoˈje]

2. into your quiet and silent bosom.

во	ти́хое	и
[vo]	[ˈtʲixoje]	[i]
безмле́вное	**не́дро**	**свое́.**
[bʲezˈmlʲevnoje]	[ˈnʲedro]	[svoˈje]

3. Do not rebuke, O wilderness, with your terrors

Не	брани́,	пусты́ня,	страши́лищи	свои́ми
[nʲe]	[braˈnʲi]	[pusˈtɨnʲa]	[straˈʂɨlʲiɕːi]	[svoˈimʲi]

4. one who has fled from the wicked harlot of this world.

отобе́гошаго	от	лука́вныя
[otoˈbʲegoʂago]	[ot]	[luˈkavnɨja]
блудни́ца	**ми́ра**	**сего́.**
[bludˈnʲitsa]	[ˈmʲira]	[sʲeˈgo]

5. O beautiful wilderness, joyful little grove!

О	прекра́сеная	пусты́ни,	весе́лая	дубра́вица!
[o]	[prʲe'krasʲenaja]	[pus'tɨnʲi]	[vʲe'sʲelaja]	[du'bravʲitsa]

6. For I have loved you more than royal chambers

Возлюби́х	бо	тя
[vozlʲu'bʲix]	[bo]	[tʲa]
па́че	ца́рескых	черто́г
['patɕe]	['tsarʲeskʲix]	[tɕer'tok]

7. and gilded palaces.

и	позлаще́нных	пола́т.
[i]	[pozla'ɕːenːɨx]	[po'lat]

8. And I will go through the meadows, through your fair vineyard,

И	пойду́	в	лу́зех
[i]	[poj'du]	[v]	['luzʲex]
по	кра́сному	твоему́	виногра́ду
[po]	['krasnomu]	[tvoje'mu]	[vʲino'gradu]

9. of your many-colored flowers,

разли́чных	цвете́ць	твои́х,
[raz'lʲitɕnɨx]	[tsvʲe'tʲets]	[tvo'ix]

10. breathing the air with a gentle breeze,

дыха́юще	от	во́здуха	ма́лым	ветре́цем,
[dɨ'xajuɕːe]	[ot]	['vozduxa]	['malɨm]	[vʲe'trʲetsem]

11. stirring the curly branches of the trees.

дви́жуще	у	древе́с
['dvʲiʐuɕːe]	[u]	[drʲe'vʲes]
ве́твие	свое́	кудря́вое.
['vʲetvʲije]	[svo'je]	[ku'drʲavoje]

12. And I will be like a lowly beast, wandering alone,

И	бу́ду,	я́ко	худ
[i]	['budu]	['jako]	[xut]
зверь,	еди́н	скыта́яся,	
[zvʲerʲ]	[je'dʲin]	[skʲi'tajasʲa]	

13. fleeing people and the great turmoil of this life,

и	бе́гая	челове́к	и
[i]	['bʲegaja]	[tɕelo'vʲek]	[i]
мно́го	**мяте́жныя**	**се́я**	**жи́зни,**
['mnogo]	[mʲa'tʲezʲnɨja]	['sʲeja]	['zɨznʲi]

14. and sitting, weeping and sobbing,

и	седя́	пла́ча	и	рыда́я,
[i]	[sʲe'dʲa]	['platɕa]	[i]	[rɨ'daja]

15. in your deep and wild bosom.

во	глубо́ком	и
[vo]	[glu'bokom]	[i]
ди́ком	**не́дре**	**твое́м.**
['dʲikom]	['nʲedrʲe]	[tvo'jem]

16. O Master and King! You have let me delight in earthly good things;

О	Влады́ко	Царю́!	Наслади́л
[o]	[vla'dɨko]	[tsa'rʲu]	[nasla'dʲil]
мя	**еси́**	**земены́хо**	**бла́го,**
[mʲa]	[je'sʲi]	[zʲemʲe'nɨxo]	['blago]

17. do not deprive me of Your Heavenly Kingdom.

и	не	лиши́	мене́
[i]	[nʲe]	[lʲi'ʂɨ]	[mʲe'nʲe]
Небе́снаго	**Ца́рествия**		**Твоего́.**
[nʲe'bʲesnago]	['tsarʲestvʲija]		[tvoje'go]

Notes on this text

- **Khomonic forms in this text** (sung with the extra vowel): отобе́гошаго (= отбе́гшаго), прекра́сеная (= прекра́сная), ца́рескых (= ца́рских), земены́хо (= земны́х), Ца́рествия (= Ца́рствия).
- **Worth checking against your source:** безмле́вное is transcribed as written; the ordinary word is безмо́лвное [bʲez'molvnoje]. блудни́ца would normally be genitive блудни́цы [blud'nʲitsɨ] after *от*. цвете́ць: the final ь is silent ([ts] stays hard).
- **позлаще́нных:** double н is sung long [nː]. **ве́твие:** four syllables, ['vʲe.tvʲi.je].
- **Stress caution:** ветре́цем, седя́, лу́зех follow standard Church Slavonic stress; if your chant source marks otherwise, follow it.

Pronunciation conventions

Tradition. Russian Church Slavonic singing pronunciation: every unstressed vowel is sung pure (okanye — *о* stays [o], *е* stays [e]; no Russian vowel reduction). Stress is marked ' before the stressed syllable and with an acute on the Cyrillic.

Extra vowels are sung. Spellings such as *Солнеце, страшеныи, смертеную, прекрасеная, земеныхо* are the “khomonic” (раздельноречие) forms of znamenny chant, in which lost yers are vocalized as full syllables. They are transcribed as written, with the stress staying where it falls in the ordinary word.

Consonants. ʲ = palatalized (“soft”). *г* = [g] (including endings *-аго/-его*, never [v]). *ч* [tɕ], *щ* [ɕː], *ш* [ʂ], *ж* [ʐ], *ц* [ts] (always hard), *х* [x], *ы* [ɨ]. Word-final voiced consonants devoice as in Russian (*Суд* [sut]).

Archaic кы / гы. Older spellings *кы, гы* are read as soft [kʲi], [gʲi] in present-day church practice (an older, harder [kɨ] is also heard among Old Believers).

Final -ыи / -ии / -ои = [ɨj] / [ij] / [oj], one syllable, unless your setting deliberately gives the [i] its own note.

а	о	у	ы	и	е	я	ю
[a]	[o]	[u]	[ɨ]	[i]	[je / ʲe]	[ja / ʲa]	[ju / ʲu]
ч	**щ**	**ш**	**ж**	**ц**	**х**	**г**	**ь**
[tɕ]	[ɕː]	[ʂ]	[ʐ]	[ts]	[x]	[g]	[ʲ]